Ex no.2: Setting Up a Zoho Creator Account and Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

AIM

To create and configure a **Zoho Creator account** and explore the **platform architecture, development environment, navigation interface, application components, forms, reports, pages, workflows, and settings** available in Zoho Creator.

THEORY

Zoho Creator

Zoho Creator is a **low-code application development platform** that allows users to create business applications using visual development tools, drag-and-drop components, forms, reports, workflows, pages, and minimal programming.

It provides an integrated environment for designing applications, storing and managing data, automating business processes, and generating reports and dashboards.

PROCEDURE

Step 1: Create a Zoho Creator Account

1. Open a web browser.
2. Navigate to the **Zoho Creator** website.
3. Select the option to sign up or start a free trial.
4. Enter the required account information.
5. Verify the account if required.

6. Log in to the Zoho Creator environment.

Step 2: Explore the Home Page

After logging in, examine the Creator home page.

Identify the major sections such as:

- Applications
- Create New Application
- Existing Applications
- Templates
- Settings
- Help and Support

Step 3: Create an Application

1. Select **Create New Application**.
2. Choose the option to create an application from scratch.
3. Enter an appropriate application name.
4. Create the application.
5. Open the application in the Creator development environment.

For this experiment, the application can be named:

Vehicle Service & Repair Management

Step 4: Explore the Application Builder

Open the application builder and identify the major development components:

- Forms
- Reports
- Pages
- Workflows
- Schedules
- Functions

- Connections
- Settings

These components form the main development environment for creating and managing the application.

Step 5: Explore Forms

1. Select **Forms** from the application builder.
2. Create or open a form.
3. Examine the field palette.
4. Identify different field types such as:
    - Single Line
    - Number
    - Email
    - Phone
    - Date
    - Date-Time
    - Dropdown
    - Radio
    - Checkbox
    - Address
    - File Upload
5. Drag fields into the form.
6. Examine field properties and validation options.

Step 6: Explore Reports

1. Open the **Reports** section.
2. Examine the available report types.
3. Identify List, Spreadsheet, Kanban, Calendar, Map, Timeline, Pivot Table, and Chart reports.

4. Observe how reports display records submitted through forms.

Step 7: Explore Pages

1. Open the **Pages** section.
2. Examine the page builder.
3. Identify components such as:
    - Reports
    - Charts
    - Panels
    - Buttons
    - Text
    - Images
4. Observe how pages can be used to create dashboards and customized application interfaces.

Step 8: Explore Workflows

1. Open the **Workflows** section.
2. Examine different workflow triggers.
3. Identify events such as record creation, record editing, and record deletion.
4. Observe how workflows can automate application processes.

Step 9: Explore Application Settings

Open the application settings and examine options related to:

- Application configuration
- Users and permissions
- Data management
- Security
- Integrations
- Notifications

- Application deployment

RESULT

The **Zoho Creator account was successfully created and configured**, and the major components of the Zoho Creator platform were explored. Thus, the experiment successfully demonstrated the basic setup and working environment of the Zoho Creator low-code development platform.